

01 · THE SERIES

THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC

THREE PERSPECTIVES
INSIDE ONE DYNAMIC



YOU ARE EITHER THE COACH, THE DAUGHTER, OR THE TEAMMATE. EACH EXPERIENCE IS VALID.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Three Perspectives Inside One Dynamic

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02

The Coach-Parent: Wearing Two Hats

Coming up.

03

The Daughter: Performing for Your Parent

Coming up.

04

The Teammates: Watching How Fairness Works

Coming up.

05

The Advantages No One Talks About

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC IS MORE COMMON THAN MOST PEOPLE TALK ABOUT, AND MORE NUANCED THAN MOST PEOPLE HANDLE.

There are three distinct experiences inside this dynamic: the coach who is also a parent, the daughter who is also an athlete, and the teammates who are navigating both. Each perspective deserves real space and real solutions.

— THREE PERSPECTIVES, ONE TEAM · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE THREE ROLES

BEFORE YOU CAN SOLVE THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC, YOU HAVE TO UNDERSTAND WHICH ROLE YOU ARE IN, AND HONOR ALL THREE.

→ The coach: navigating authority, love, and the appearance of fairness simultaneously

→ The daughter: performing for her parent while also needing a parent

→ The teammate: watching a dynamic she didn't choose and learning from how it's handled

— EVERY ROLE IN THIS DYNAMIC CARRIES A REAL AND VALID BURDEN.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

INSIDE EACH ROLE

THE COACH

Constantly scrutinized for favoritism, real or perceived. Every decision involving her daughter is a public one.

THE DAUGHTER

Can never just be an athlete. Always also a child in a parent's professional space.

THE TEAMMATE

Watching how authority and relationship intersect, this is a formative lesson about fairness.



NAMING THE EXPERIENCE

IN PRACTICE

Start by naming which role you're in, this dynamic affects you differently depending on your position.

WATCH FOR

Whether conversations about this dynamic acknowledge all three perspectives or only the loudest one.

THE SHIFT

From seeing this as a problem to solve to seeing it as a dynamic to navigate with awareness.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

BEFORE YOU REACT TO THIS DYNAMIC,
ASK: HAVE YOU TRULY CONSIDERED
ALL THREE PERSPECTIVES? BECAUSE
ALL THREE ARE IN THE ROOM.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, IDENTIFY YOUR ROLE IN THIS DYNAMIC.

- ✓ Determine which role applies to you: coach, daughter, or teammate's parent
- ✓ List the specific challenges your role creates in this dynamic
- ✓ Identify what the other two roles might be experiencing that you haven't considered
- ✓ Share one observation from another role's perspective with someone in this dynamic



THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC

THE COACH-PARENT:
WEARING TWO HATS

02

YOU CANNOT FULLY BE BOTH AT ONCE. YOU HAVE TO KNOW WHEN TO SWITCH.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE COACH-PARENT IS NOT FAILING
AT BOTH ROLES, THEY ARE
NAVIGATING A STRUCTURAL
IMPOSSIBILITY THAT DESERVES
PRACTICAL TOOLS, NOT CRITICISM.

Coaching your daughter means every public decision is personal. Every professional call is an emotional one. And every moment of standards-setting is watched by other parents to see whether you will hold them for her the way you hold them for everyone else.

— CLARITY OF ROLE IN THE MOMENT IS EVERYTHING · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE DUAL ROLE

YOU CANNOT BE THE COACH AND THE MOM
SIMULTANEOUSLY IN THE SAME MOMENT.
DECIDE WHICH ROLE THE MOMENT CALLS
FOR.

→ On the court: you are the coach. Hold the same standards for your daughter that you hold for everyone else.

→ Off the court: you are the mom. Create space that is completely separate from the sport.

→ The transition: make it explicit, both for yourself and for her.

— CLARITY OF ROLE IN THE MOMENT PROTECTS BOTH RELATIONSHIPS.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE TRANSITIONS

ON THE COURT

In practice and games, the daughter must be held to the same, or higher, standard. No exceptions visible to the team.



OFF THE COURT

After practice, the mom needs to be present. Not the coach. Not the analyst. The mom.

THE SIGNAL

Create a deliberate transition signal, a phrase, a moment, a space, that marks the switch between roles.



THE TRANSITION PRACTICE

IN PRACTICE

Design one explicit transition: 'Once we leave the gym, I'm your mom. Ask me anything. Coach stays at the gym.'

WATCH FOR

Whether you bring coach energy home or parent energy to the court, both are costly when misplaced.

THE SHIFT

From bleeding roles into each other to clearly marking the transitions for both of you.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE DUAL ROLE IS MANAGEABLE.
THE BLURRED ROLE IS NOT. CREATE
THE TRANSITIONS, AND PROTECT
THEM.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, DESIGN ONE EXPLICIT ROLE TRANSITION.

✓ Choose a transition moment: end of practice, leaving the gym parking lot, a specific phrase

✓ Make it explicit to your daughter: 'This is where I switch from coach to mom.'

✓ Honor the transition consistently for one week

✓ Ask your daughter after one week: 'Does this feel different? Better?'



THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC

THE DAUGHTER:
PERFORMING FOR YOUR
PARENT

03

THE EMOTIONAL WEIGHT OF BEING COACHED BY YOUR PARENT IS REAL. IT DESERVES A REAL CONVERSATION.

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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE COACH'S DAUGHTER IS
CARRYING SOMETHING NO ONE ELSE
ON THE TEAM CARRIES: SHE IS
PERFORMING FOR SOMEONE WHOSE
LOVE SHE NEEDS.

Every athlete wants to impress her coach. But when the coach is also the mom, the emotional stakes of every performance are fundamentally different. That weight needs to be named and separated from the sport.

— NAME THE WEIGHT BEFORE IT NAMES YOU · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE DAUGHTER WHO IS COACHED BY HER PARENT IS NAVIGATING SOMETHING UNIQUELY DIFFICULT. START BY NAMING IT.

- The fear of disappointing her parent, which also means her coach, is amplified
- Public correction from mom feels different than public correction from any other coach
- Her love, her performance, and her identity are all mixed together in the same space

— LOVE AND ACCOUNTABILITY MUST BE CLEARLY SEPARATED IN THIS DYNAMIC.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE SEPARATION

LOVE IS UNCONDITIONAL

Make this explicit and regular, not earned by performance, not withdrawn after a bad game.



COACHING IS CONDITIONAL

Standards, corrections, and expectations are about growth,not love.

THE BLEND PROBLEM

When these are not separated, the daughter cannot receive coaching without feeling her relationship at risk.

THE EXPLICIT CONVERSATION

IN PRACTICE

Have one conversation, outside of practice, that explicitly separates coaching from love.

WATCH FOR

Whether she responds to your coaching with increased anxiety or withdrawal, these are signs the blend is happening.

THE SHIFT

From assuming she knows the difference to making it explicit, regularly and proactively.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

SHE NEEDS TO KNOW: MY MOM
LOVES ME WITHOUT CONDITIONS. MY
COACH HOLDS ME TO STANDARDS.
BOTH ARE TRUE. NEITHER IS THE
SAME THING.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, HAVE THE EXPLICIT CONVERSATION.

- ✓ Find a moment outside the gym, in the car, at dinner, to say this explicitly
- ✓ 'When I coach you, I am holding you to a standard. That has nothing to do with how much I love you.'
- ✓ Ask: 'Does that feel clear to you? What would help?'
- ✓ Commit to revisiting this conversation once a month, not once



THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC

THE TEAMMATES:
WATCHING HOW FAIRNESS
WORKS



EVERY OTHER ATHLETE ON THE TEAM IS LEARNING FROM HOW THIS DYNAMIC IS HANDLED.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE TEAMMATES OF THE COACH'S DAUGHTER ARE RECEIVING A FORMATIVE LESSON IN FAIRNESS, AUTHORITY, AND INTEGRITY, BASED ENTIRELY ON HOW THIS DYNAMIC PLAYS OUT.

If the coach is perceived to show favoritism, the whole team's trust in the system erodes. If the coach is visibly fair, or even harder on her daughter, the team learns that standards are real and leadership has integrity.

— THE TEAM IS WATCHING HOW FAIRNESS GETS MODELED · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE TEAM LESSON

THE REST OF THE TEAM IS NOT JUST WATCHING THE COACH'S KID. THEY ARE LEARNING WHAT FAIRNESS LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE.

- Perceived favoritism, even if unintentional, erodes team culture fast
- Visible consistency, same standards, same accountability, builds trust with everyone
- The team lesson on fairness and integrity will outlast the season

— HOW YOU HANDLE THIS DYNAMIC IS A LEADERSHIP LESSON YOUR WHOLE TEAM IS RECEIVING.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

WHAT THE TEAM SEES

PLAYING TIME

Does the coach's daughter play more than her merit warrants? The team calculates this constantly.

CORRECTIONS

Is she corrected in the same voice, the same frequency as others? Or protected?

STANDARDS

Is she held to the same practice standards? Her effort in drills is visible to everyone.



BUILDING TEAM TRUST

IN PRACTICE

Audit the last two weeks: has the coach’s daughter been held to the same standard? In every visible way?

WATCH FOR

Side conversations among teammates, this is where perception of fairness lives first.

THE SHIFT

From managing the appearance of fairness to building the practice of it.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE TEAM WILL FORGIVE IMPERFECT COACHING. THEY WILL NOT FORGIVE VISIBLE FAVORITISM, REAL OR PERCEIVED. HOLD THE STANDARD.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, AUDIT FOR VISIBLE CONSISTENCY.

- ✓ Review the last two practices: was the coach's daughter held to the same standard in every visible moment?
- ✓ Identify one area where the standard may have slipped, and correct it next practice
- ✓ Ask a trusted colleague or parent: 'From the outside, does this dynamic look fair?'
- ✓ Adjust based on the feedback, not the discomfort



THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC

THE ADVANTAGES
NO ONE TALKS ABOUT

OS

BEING THE COACH'S KID IS HARD. IT ALSO COMES WITH GIFTS THAT ARE WORTH NAMING.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE CONVERSATION ABOUT THE
COACH'S KID DYNAMIC ALMOST
ALWAYS FOCUSES ON THE BURDEN.
THE ADVANTAGES DESERVE EQUAL
ATTENTION.

The daughter who is coached by her parent, when the dynamic is handled well, receives access, insight, and modeling that most athletes never get. She sees the game from two levels simultaneously. That is not a small thing.

— THE GIFT IS IN THE ACCESS · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE GIFT

THE COACH'S KID DYNAMIC IS HARD. IT IS ALSO, WHEN HANDLED WELL, ONE OF THE RICHEST DEVELOPMENTAL ENVIRONMENTS IN SPORT.

→ She sees the game from the court and from the coach's perspective simultaneously

→ She learns leadership, accountability, and fairness from the inside

→ She has a mentor who is also invested in her at the deepest possible level

— THE PRIVILEGE AND THE BURDEN LIVE IN THE SAME ROOM. OWN BOTH.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE ACCESS ADVANTAGE

TACTICAL ACCESS

She hears how the coach thinks about the game, the team, the system, in real time, at home.



LEADERSHIP MODELING

She watches how a leader makes hard decisions, playing time, team culture, accountability.

INVESTED MENTORSHIP

Her coach is also her mother, the investment in her development has no off switch.



NAMING THE GIFTS

IN PRACTICE

Ask your daughter: 'What do you understand about the game now that you didn't a year ago from being in this role?'

WATCH FOR

Whether she is accessing the tactical knowledge available to her or just experiencing the burden.

THE SHIFT

From focusing only on what's hard about this dynamic to actively mining it for the gifts inside it.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

SHE IS SEEING THE GAME FROM THE
INSIDE. MOST ATHLETES NEVER GET
THAT. HELP HER USE IT.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, MINE THE ADVANTAGE.

✓ Ask your daughter: 'What's one thing you understand about volleyball because of this dynamic that other athletes don't?'

✓ Name one gift from this week, something she learned by being in this unique position

✓ Write it down, these are the things she'll look back on with gratitude

✓ Remind her: the burden is real AND the gift is real. Both deserve space.

